

air pressure variations. Microphones typically need to be connected to a preamplifier before the signal can be recorded or reproduced.

One type of microphones are condenser microphones. Here the diaphragm has to behave as one plate of the capacitor. Dynamic microphones, on



A Sennheiser dynamic microphone

the other hand, reverse the principle of a loudspeaker to function. They are relatively inexpensive and easier to manufacture.

Ribbon microphones also use the principle of magnetic induction. A thin corrugated metal ribbon is suspended in a magnetic field, and its vibration within the electric field generates the recording.

Then there are fibre optic microphones too, which converts acoustic waves into electrical signals by sensing changes in light intensity, instead of sensing changes in capacitance or magnetic fields as with conventional microphones.

TO CONCLUDE

While the world of Audio Tech is vast, the above was a brief look at what it means to us and most consumers. In the chapters that follow we'll take a look at many of these components of Audio Tech closely including ones that we haven't mentioned here such as digital file formats (modern day storage of audio), streaming, connector types, cables and more. 